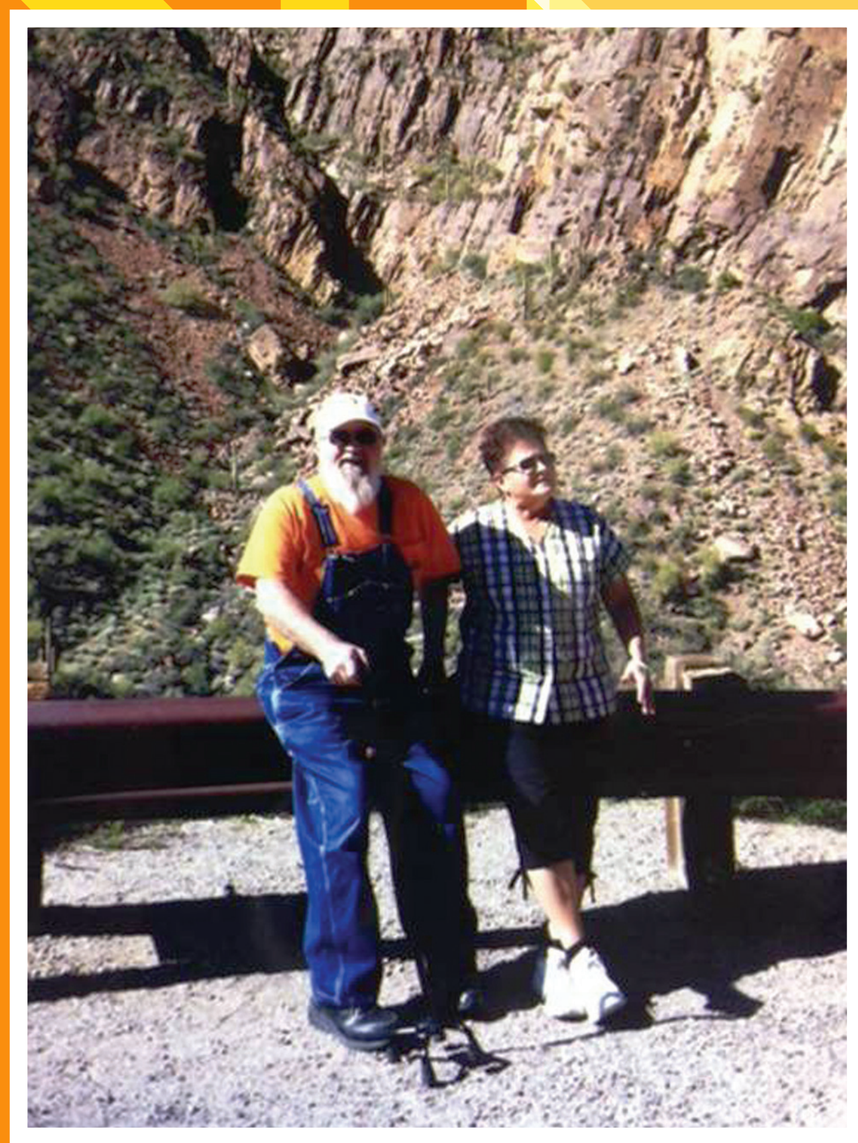
VICTIM SEVERELY INJURED BY DRUNK DRIVING CRASH

Sunday, St. Patrick's Day, 2013 Mark Engen was driving a Buick Lucerne to pick up his wife at the airport. His journey was cut short at 2:19 pm when a vehicle crossed over the center line and hit him head on. This vehicle was driven by a drunk driver. Mark had to be cut from his car and was taken to Grand Forks Altru Hospital. There they discovered that both of his legs were broken and ankles crushed, he had a severed right leg patellar tendon, a shattered hip, every bone in his face was broken except his nose, and he had a brain bleed. After two emergency surgeries in Grand Forks, Mark is flown to Hennepin County Medical Center (HCMC) where a trauma team immediately starts the third surgery to start to repair his broken body. The surgery has to be stopped halfway because of so much blood loss.



An 8 ½ hour surgery repaired Mark's face. He ate pureed food for 45 days and lost over 50 pounds. He was not able to have teeth for 7 months! He had to sleep on an air bed for months to relieve the pressure on all the broken bones. A total of 9 major surgeries were needed to try to repair the injuries. Bone grafts were needed and when bone wouldn't heal, his ankle was fused and would no longer have any movement. A bone infection resulted in 17 day hospital stay one year after the accident. Mark was in a hospital setting for six months in 2013 as a result of the accident. He lost two summers of his life being laid up and did not walk on both feet until 2015. Today he walks carefully with a cane.

A few costs of this accident are: $16,530.00 flight to HCMC, $54,000.00 Grand Forks, $400,000.00 HCMC, $30,000.00 skilled nursing care, $15,000.00 physical therapy. This doesn't include: medical transport, months of hotel/extended stay living for Mark's wife, specialized handicap equipment, medications, etc. These costs had to be covered by insurance companies, medical facilities, tax payers, and the Engens.

Can you assign a cost to the pain and suffering a human being has to endure because of other people's decision to "road pack"? How sad that Mark's retirement dreams can't include a physically active lifestyle like he once led. How instead, he has to carry a letter explaining to airport security why there is so much metal in his body.

MSD
Minnesotans *for* Safe Driving

A quote from Jeanine, Mark's wife, sums it all up:
"If people went through an accident like this, I'm sure they would drive different and always have on their mind to be careful to prevent hurting anyone to this degree. It hurts the victim, his family, children, friends, the townspeople; creates huge expenses, changes lives and prevents the victim from resuming his daily life."